NETFLIX INDIA
Visual Design System Reference

Implementation-focused guide for AI coding agents
to restyle an existing website with a Netflix-like cinematic aesthetic
without changing functionality, business logic, or application behavior.

Source analyzed: https://www.netflix.com/in/ (marketing / signup homepage)
Document purpose: design tokens, component recipes, CSS variables, agent rules
Scope: visual styling only — not a trademark or brand-asset license

Document type	Design system / token reference
Primary brand red	#E50914
Canvas	#000000
Typeface	Netflix Sans → Helvetica Neue / Segoe UI / Roboto / Ubuntu / sans-serif
Shape language	8px radius family (cards, CTA, inputs, FAQ)
Depth model	Tone ladder (no box-shadows on marketing chrome)
Audience	AI coding agent performing CSS/theme restyle

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4. Color system (tokens, roles, swatches)

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Appendix A — Quick token cheat sheet

2. How an AI agent should use this document

This PDF is a **styling contract**. Treat it as the source of visual truth when restyling an existing application. Apply tokens and patterns to presentation layers (CSS, templates, component class names). Do **not** alter routes, forms' server handlers, authentication, database models, validation rules, or business workflows.

Priority order when conflicting guidance appears

1. Preserve existing functionality and DOM structure needed by JS/backend.

2. Apply color, typography, spacing, radius, and surface tokens from this doc.

3. Match component *visual recipes* (button fill, input height) without renaming server fields.

4. Prefer CSS variables / theme files over hardcoded one-off colors.

5. When unsure, choose the darker surface and higher contrast — Netflix is cinema-dark.

Safe change surface (allowed)

- Global CSS / SCSS / Tailwind theme tokens
- Template class names and presentational markup wrappers
- Button, input, card, navbar, footer, accordion visual styles
- Backgrounds, overlays, gradients, borders, focus rings
- Font stacks and type scale mappings

Forbidden change surface (never touch for “Netflix look”)

- View logic, serializers, models, migrations, URL routing
- Form field names, CSRF handling, auth middleware, permissions
- API contracts, query parameters, session behavior
- Copying Netflix trademarks, wordmark SVG, or proprietary Netflix Sans font files into production without license

Font licensing note: Netflix Sans is proprietary. For a third-party site, use the documented fallback stack (Helvetica Neue, Segoe UI, Roboto, Ubuntu, sans-serif) or a licensed open alternative (e.g. Inter Black for hero + Inter Regular for body) while preserving the weight silhouette described in §5.

3. Visual theme & atmosphere

Netflix India's public homepage feels like a **streaming theater before the lights come up**: a pure black canvas, movie-poster artwork carrying almost all color, and a single red "ticket" CTA. The UI is conversion-first (email capture + Get Started) and content-first (trending posters, feature tiles, FAQ).

Mood keywords

Cinematic · High-contrast · Dark · Direct · Promotional-but-not-playful · Media-first · Conversion-oriented · Disciplined red accent

Design density

Medium–high information density in carousels and FAQ, but low visual chrome. Dark backgrounds and strong section separation keep modules readable. Whitespace is purposeful and vertical (large section gutters), not airy "startup landing page" whitespace.

Page architecture (marketing funnel)

#	Section	Role
1	Top nav	Logo left · language picker · red Sign In
2	Hero	Display headline · price line · email + CTA
3	Trending rail	Horizontal posters + outline rank numerals
4	Reasons to join	2×2 / 4-col feature cards with illustration space
5	FAQ accordion	Stacked charcoal rows with + / × chevron
6	Secondary email CTA	Repeat of email + Get Started
7	Footer	Muted link columns + legal caption

4. Color system

Palette discipline is the brand. Red is a **single-voltage accent** used sparingly for actions and logo emphasis. Almost everything else is black, charcoal, white, or muted gray. Gradients appear mainly behind the trending rail — not as page washes.

4.1 Core surfaces

Canvas
#000000
Page base

Surface Deep
#161616
Rail backdrop

Surface Card
#232323
FAQ / feature

Surface Input
#2D2D2D
Email field

Panel alt
#181818
Alt tile surface

Charcoal
#141414
Legacy card bg

Hairline
#414141
Borders / rules

Border soft
#333333
Tile strokes

4.2 Brand & accent

Netflix Red
#E50914
CTA / Sign In

Red Hover
#C11119
Primary hover

Dark Red
#B20710
N symbol depth

Focus Ring
#A9A9A9
Focus default

4.3 Text & ink

Ink Base
#FFFFFF
Headings / body

Ink Soft
#B3B3B3
Secondary copy

Ink Muted
#808080
Footer / legal

Ink Dim
#A9A9A9
Focus / helpers

4.4 Gradient stops (trending rail wash)

Navy
#192247
Rail left

Wine
#210E17
Rail mid

Burgundy
#461518
Rail right

Oxblood
#6F181D
Far accent

Trending-rail linear gradient (navy → wine → burgundy → oxblood)

4.5 Token roles (implementation map)

Token	Hex	Role / usage rules
--nf-canvas	#000000	html/body background; nav; footer

Token	Hex	Role / usage rules
--nf-surface-deep	#161616	Carousel / rail container
--nf-surface-card	#232323	Cards, FAQ rows, secondary buttons
--nf-surface-input	#2D2D2D	Text inputs on dark chrome
--nf-red	#E50914	Primary CTA + Sign In ONLY
--nf-red-hover	#C11119	Hover / active for primary CTA
--nf-ink	#FFFFFF	Primary text on dark
--nf-ink-soft	#B3B3B3	Supporting body / placeholders
--nf-ink-muted	#808080	Footer links, legal, captions
--nf-hairline	#414141	1px borders, dividers
--nf-border	#333333	Optional tile outline
--nf-overlay	rgba(0,0,0,.64)	Hero image darkening
--nf-focus	rgba(255,255,255,.9)	Visible focus ring on dark

4.6 Color frequency discipline

- Use Netflix Red on CTAs and critical auth entry points — not on body links, badges everywhere, or panel backgrounds.
- Never use burgundy/oxblood as button fills; they are gradient stops only.
- Body text is white (#FFFFFF), not gray. Gray is for secondary/footer only.
- Do not invent a light-mode Netflix marketing skin for this aesthetic; the system assumes dark canvas + bright posters.

5. Typography

One family everywhere. Hierarchy comes from **size + weight**, not from mixing serif/sans. The signature silhouette is a very heavy hero against light body weight.

5.1 Font stack

```
font-family: "Netflix Sans", "Helvetica Neue", "Segoe UI",
             Roboto, Ubuntu, sans-serif;
```

Observed weights on the live site / extracts: **400** (body), **500** (section titles, CTA labels), **700** or **900** (hero display depending on measurement source). For agent implementation, prefer: hero **800–900**, emphasis **500**, body **400**. Avoid filling the middle with 600/700 body headings.

5.2 Type scale

Token	Size	Weight	Line-height	Color	Use
hero-display	56px → 32px	900 / 700	1.25 (≈70px)	#FFFFFF	Main hero H1
section-title	24px	500	1.2–normal	#FFFFFF	Trending / Reasons
accordion-title	24px	400	normal	#FFFFFF	FAQ question row
button-label	16–24px	500	1.0	#FFFFFF	Get Started CTA
body-emphasis	20px	500	normal	#FFFFFF	Ready to watch?
body-base	16px	400	1.5 (24px)	#FFFFFF	Descriptions, labels
body-sm	14px	400–500	1.5 (21px)	#FFFFFF / #808080	Nav, footer links
legal-caption	13px	400	normal	#808080	Copyright / reCAPTCHA
price-line	16–20px	400	1.4	#FFFFFF	Starts at ₹149…

5.3 Typography principles for agents

• Keep headlines short, forceful, and white on black.
• Tighten letter-spacing slightly on large display (-0.01em to -0.02em) if the fallback font feels loose.
• Do not use decorative serifs, monospace UI, or multi-font “editorial” mixes for this aesthetic.
• CTA label weight should feel medium (500), not ultra-bold — the red fill carries the emphasis.
• Outline-stroked giant numerals behind posters are a signature for ranked lists — optional on non-media sites; if used, stroke-only white/light glyphs, not filled.

6. Spacing, layout & grid

Base unit is effectively **8px**, with micro 2–3px steps and large 24 / 64px section rhythm. Horizontal gutters on desktop are unusually generous.

6.1 Spacing scale

Token	Value	Typical use
--space-xxs	2px	Hairline offsets, micro gaps
--space-xs	3–4px	Icon nudge, tight stacks
--space-sm	8px	Compact control padding, card gaps
--space-md	12px	Internal tile rhythm
--space-base	16px	Nav padding, form gaps
--space-lg	24px	Card / FAQ internal padding
--space-xl	32px	Module separation
--space-2xl	48px	Section padding (compact)
--space-3xl	64px	Major section gutters
--page-gutter-desktop	≈80–148px	Left/right page margin at ≥1280px
--page-gutter-mobile	16px	Collapsed gutters
--btn-pad	8px 22px	Primary CTA padding
--input-height	56px	Email field height

6.2 Layout principles

- Linear single-column funnel on marketing pages — no sidebars, no dashboard chrome.
- Primary conversion control (email + CTA) appears above the fold and again after FAQ.
- Content rails scroll horizontally; sections stack vertically.
- Feature grids: 4 columns desktop → 2×2 tablet → 1 column mobile.
- Max content width feels centered with large side gutters; avoid edge-to-edge text blocks.
- Cards may use heavy bottom padding when an illustration sits under copy (e.g. 24px 16px 128px).

6.3 Border radius scale

Token	Value	Use
--radius-xs	2–4px	Language picker, small chrome, Sign In (tighter)
--radius-md	8px	DEFAULT: CTA, inputs, FAQ, feature cards, posters
--radius-lg	16px	Rare — logo glyph container / soft tiles
--radius-pill	999px	AVOID for primary CTA (breaks one-radius family)

7. Depth, elevation, borders & shadows

Netflix marketing chrome uses **almost no box-shadows**. Depth = stacked charcoal tones on black. Shadows, if any, belong to modal/product overlays — not FAQ cards.

Level	Surface	Treatment
0 Base	#000000	Page, nav, footer — flat
1 Deep	#161616	Rails — flat
2 Card	#232323	FAQ / features — flat, 8px radius
3 Input	#2D2D2D	Interactive fields — flat
Overlay	rgba(0,0,0,.5–.8)	Hero/poster readability wash
Optional product shadow	0 8px 24px rgba(0,0,0,.45)	Only if you need floating dialogs

Borders

- Default hairline: 1px solid #414141 (or #333333 on tiles).
- Inputs often rely on fill contrast more than heavy borders; focus may brighten border to white.
- Avoid thick colored borders and glow outlines (no neon red rings).
- Dividers in footers: 1px #414141.

Focus rings (a11y — keep when restyling)

```
/* Netflix-like focus on dark UI */
:focus-visible {
  outline: 2px solid #FFFFFF;
  outline-offset: 2px;
}
/* Fallback observed token */
--focus-ring-color: #a9a9a9;
```

8. Gradients & overlays

8.1 Hero image overlay

Hero media sits under a dark overlay so white type stays readable. Typical recipe:

```
.hero {
  background-color: #000;
  background-image:
    linear-gradient(to top, rgba(0,0,0,.9) 0%, rgba(0,0,0,.55) 40%,
                    rgba(0,0,0,.35) 70%, rgba(0,0,0,.55) 100%),
    url(/your-hero.jpg);
  background-size: cover;
  background-position: center top;
}
```

8.2 Trending rail wash

linear-gradient(90deg, #192247, #210E17, #461518, #6F181D)

```
.trending-rail {
  background:
    linear-gradient(90deg, #192247 0%, #210E17 40%, #461518 75%, #6F181D 100%),
    #161616;
}
```

8.3 Rules

- Do not purple-wash the entire site; keep gradients sectional.
- Prefer darkening overlays over frosted glass blur for Netflix-like marketing chrome.
- Poster art should be the brightest chroma on the page.

9. Component catalog

9.1 Primary CTA button (Get Started)

Get Started ›

```
.btn-primary {
  background: #E50914;
  color: #FFFFFF;
  border: none;
  border-radius: 8px;
  padding: 8px 22px;          /* or min-height: 48px */
  font-size: 18px;            /* 16–24px acceptable */
  font-weight: 500;
  line-height: 1;
  cursor: pointer;
  display: inline-flex;
  align-items: center;
  gap: 8px;
}
.btn-primary:hover { background: #C11119; }
.btn-primary:active { background: #B20710; }
```

9.2 Sign In (nav compact)

Sign In

Same red, tighter radius (4px), smaller padding (≈4–8px × 16px), body-sm/base type. Quieter than the hero CTA but still unmistakable.

9.3 Secondary button

Secondary

Fill #232323 (or rgba(109,109,110,.7) for translucent media overlays), white text, 8px radius, no border. Used for non-primary actions on dark UI.

9.4 Email / text input

Email address

name@example.com

```
.input {
  background: #2D2D2D;                /* or rgba(22,22,22,.75) */
  color: #FFFFFF;
  border: 1px solid #666666;          /* optional; many builds borderless */
  border-radius: 8px;
  min-height: 56px;
  padding: 24px 16px 8px;             /* room for floating label */
  font-size: 16px;
  font-weight: 400;
  width: 100%;
}
.input::placeholder { color: #808080; }
.input:focus {
  outline: none;
  border-color: #FFFFFF;
}
```

9.5 Email capture composite

Desktop: horizontal flex — input grows, CTA fixed on the right, gap ≈ 8px. Mobile: stack vertically — full-width input, full-width CTA beneath. Repeat this pattern near the bottom of long pages.

9.6 Feature card

```
.feature-card {
  background: #232323;
  color: #FFFFFF;
  border-radius: 8px;
  padding: 24px 16px 48px;   /* add more bottom if illustration */
  border: none;             /* tone step provides separation */
}
.feature-card h3 { font-size: 24px; font-weight: 500; margin: 0 0 8px; }
.feature-card p  { font-size: 16px; font-weight: 400; color: #FFFFFF; }
.feature-card:hover { background: #2A2A2A; }  /* subtle lift via tone */
```

9.7 FAQ accordion row

```
.faq-row {
  background: #232323;
  color: #FFFFFF;
  border-radius: 8px;
  padding: 24px;
  margin-bottom: 8px;
  display: flex;
  justify-content: space-between;
  align-items: center;
  min-height: 72px;
  cursor: pointer;
}
.faq-row .title { font-size: 24px; font-weight: 400; }
.faq-row .icon  { font-size: 28px; font-weight: 300; } /* + / × */
.faq-panel {
  background: #232323;
  padding: 0 24px 24px;
  font-size: 16px;
  line-height: 1.5;
}
```

9.8 Poster / media tile

- 8px clipped corner radius on artwork.
- No heavy card chrome — the image is the component.
- Optional rank numeral: large outline stroke behind/beside the poster.
- Horizontal scroll container with snap optional; keep posters large enough to read titles.

9.9 Top navigation

- Background transparent or #000; no drop shadow; no bottom border required.
- Logo left; utilities right (language + Sign In).
- Padding ≈ 16px vertical; horizontal aligned to page gutters.
- On scroll over hero imagery, keep high-contrast red Sign In.

9.10 Footer

- Canvas #000 background.
- Link text #808080 at 14px; hover to #FFFFFF underline optional.
- Multi-column link lists on desktop; stacked on mobile.
- Legal caption 13px muted.

10. Motion & interaction states

Motion is restrained. Prefer short opacity/height transitions over bounce or parallax.

Interaction	Behavior	Suggested CSS
Button hover	Darken red ~10–15%	background #C11119; transition 150ms ease
Card hover	Slightly lighter charcoal	background #2A2A2A; 150–200ms
FAQ expand	Inline height reveal	grid-template-rows / max-height 200–300ms ease
FAQ chevron	+ rotates to ×	transform rotate; 200ms
Input focus	Border → white	border-color #fff; 100ms
Rail scroll	Horizontal drag/wheel	overflow-x:auto; scroll-snap optional

Respect **prefers-reduced-motion: reduce** — disable non-essential transitions.

11. Responsive behavior

Breakpoint	Width	Key behavior
Mobile S	<425px	16px gutters; 1-col cards; hero ~32px; CTA stacks
Mobile	425–576px	Hero 32–40px; email+CTA vertical stack
Tablet	576–768px	Feature cards 2×2; rail still horizontal
Tablet L	768–1024px	Full-width FAQ; gutters ~16–40px
Desktop S	1024–1280px	4-col features; gutters ~80px
Desktop	1280–1440px	Standard; gutters up to ~148px; 5-tile rail
Large	>1440px	Cap content width; grow side gutters

Touch targets

- Primary CTA ≥ 44px tall.
- FAQ rows ≥ 72px tall tap area.
- Email input 56px tall.
- Avoid shrinking Sign In below ~28px height without increasing hit padding.

Collapsing rules agents must preserve

- Hero weight stays heavy at every size; only size scales down.
- Horizontal rails stay scrollable — do not squash posters into unreadably small grids.
- Email + CTA: inline on desktop, stacked on mobile.
- FAQ remains a vertical stack at all breakpoints.

12. CSS custom properties (copy-paste token sheet)

Paste into a root stylesheet / theme file. Map your existing class names to these variables instead of scattering hex values.

```
:root {
  /* Color */
  --nf-canvas: #000000;
  --nf-surface-deep: #161616;
  --nf-surface-card: #232323;
  --nf-surface-input: #2D2D2D;
  --nf-red: #E50914;
  --nf-red-hover: #C11119;
  --nf-red-active: #B20710;
  --nf-ink: #FFFFFF;
  --nf-ink-soft: #B3B3B3;
  --nf-ink-muted: #808080;
  --nf-hairline: #414141;
  --nf-border: #333333;
  --nf-overlay: rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.64);
  --nf-grad-navy: #192247;
  --nf-grad-wine: #210E17;
  --nf-grad-burgundy: #461518;
  --nf-grad-oxblood: #6F181D;

  /* Type */
  --nf-font: "Helvetica Neue", "Segoe UI", Roboto, Ubuntu, sans-serif;
  --nf-fs-hero: clamp(2rem, 4vw, 3.5rem); /* 32–56px */
  --nf-fs-section: 1.5rem;  /* 24px */
  --nf-fs-body: 1rem;       /* 16px */
  --nf-fs-sm: 0.875rem;     /* 14px */
  --nf-fs-legal: 0.8125rem; /* 13px */
  --nf-fw-hero: 800;
  --nf-fw-em: 500;
  --nf-fw-body: 400;

  /* Shape & space */
  --nf-radius: 8px;
  --nf-radius-sm: 4px;
  --nf-space-sm: 8px;
  --nf-space-md: 16px;
  --nf-space-lg: 24px;
  --nf-space-xl: 64px;
  --nf-input-h: 56px;
  --nf-gutter: clamp(16px, 8vw, 148px);

  /* Motion */
  --nf-ease: 150ms ease;
}

html, body {
  background: var(--nf-canvas);
  color: var(--nf-ink);
  font-family: var(--nf-font);
  font-weight: var(--nf-fw-body);
  line-height: 1.5;
}
```

13. Agent implementation checklist & guardrails

Before editing

• Identify theme entry points (base CSS, Bootstrap overrides, template blocks).
• List interactive forms/buttons that must keep the same name/id/action attributes.
• Screenshot current key pages for visual regression comparison.

While editing

• Introduce CSS variables first; then remap components to variables.
• Restyle buttons/inputs via classes — do not replace actions or method.
• Keep existing heading hierarchy (h1–h6) for accessibility; only change visual CSS.
• Ensure focus states remain visible on dark backgrounds.
• Maintain color contrast: white text on #232323/#000 passes; muted gray on black may fail for small text — use #B3B3B3+ for readable secondary copy.

After editing

• Click through login, create, edit, delete, search — confirm behavior unchanged.
• Check mobile widths 375 / 768 / 1280.
• Verify no broken icons/images from background changes (e.g. dark logos on dark bg).
• Remove any accidentally added Netflix wordmark assets.

Definition of done (visual)

• Page background is near-black; cards are charcoal; primary actions are #E50914.
• Typography uses a single sans stack with heavy hero / regular body contrast.
• Corners consistently ~8px; no heavy drop shadows on static cards.
• Forms remain fully usable; validation messages readable (prefer soft red/white alerts, not low-contrast gray).

14. Do's and don'ts

Do

- Reserve #E50914 for primary actions and key brand moments.
- Let imagery (or bold content blocks) supply color variety.
- Use tone steps (#000 → #161616 → #232323 → #2D2D2D) for hierarchy.
- Keep layouts linear and conversion/content focused.
- Use 8px radius as the default shape language.
- Stack generous vertical section spacing (48–64px).

Don't

- Don't introduce light cream/purple SaaS themes while claiming Netflix aesthetic.
- Don't paint large background areas red.
- Don't add colorful borders, neon glows, or multi-shadow card stacks.
- Don't pill-shape every button (radius 999px).
- Don't use gray for primary body text.
- Don't ship proprietary Netflix Sans or official logos in a third-party product.
- Don't refactor backend logic to “match Netflix” — styling only.
- Don't weaken overlays until text on images fails contrast.

15. Mapping Netflix aesthetics onto an existing site

Your application (e.g. an eDiary / EDMS Django site) is not a streaming storefront. Translate the **aesthetic system**, not the product IA. Map as follows:

Existing element	Netflix analog	Apply
App shell / body	Canvas	bg #000; text #FFF
Navbar	Top nav	dark bar; red primary auth/action btn
Primary submit	Get Started CTA	btn-primary red 8px
Secondary actions	Secondary btn	#232323 fill
Cards / panels	Feature / FAQ surfaces	#232323; 8px; no shadow
Tables	Dense dark lists	deep surface header; hairline #414141
Forms	Email input chrome	#2D2D2D fields; white labels
Alerts success	—	keep semantic green; don't force red
Alerts error	Brand red family	use #E50914 / #C11119 sparingly
Hero / landing	Hero + overlay	dark overlay + heavy headline
Footer	Footer band	muted #808080 links
Modals	Elevated surface	#181818–#232323; optional shadow

Agent prompt snippet (paste when restyling):

Restyle this site to a Netflix-India-like cinematic dark aesthetic using the token sheet in Netflix_India_Design_System_Reference.pdf. Use black/charcoal surfaces, white text, #E50914 for primary CTAs only, 8px radii, no card box-shadows, single sans fallback stack, heavy display / regular body type. Change CSS and presentational classes only — do not modify business logic, form actions, models, or routes.

Appendix A — Quick token cheat sheet

Need	Use
Page background	#000000
Card / FAQ / panel	#232323
Input fill	#2D2D2D
Primary button	bg #E50914 · hover #C11119 · text #FFF · radius 8px
Body text	#FFFFFF · 16px · weight 400
Secondary text	#B3B3B3 or #808080
Section title	24px · weight 500 · #FFF
Hero title	clamp(32px, 4vw, 56px) · weight 800–900
Default radius	8px
Section gap	64px
Page gutter	clamp(16px, 8vw, 148px)
Hairline	1px solid #414141
Shadow	none (prefer tone steps)
Font	Helvetica Neue, Segoe UI, Roboto, Ubuntu, sans-serif
Focus	2px solid #FFF; offset 2px

Appendix B — Sources & confidence

Primary live source: Netflix India homepage HTML/CSS (assets.nflxext.com nmhp stylesheet; inline design tokens). Cross-checked against public design-token writeups derived from the same marketing surface (color frequency, type scale, radius statistics) and Netflix brand red guidance (#E50914 / #B20710). Measurements can drift as Netflix ships UI experiments; prefer tokens and principles over pixel-perfect cloning.

End of reference. Apply visually. Preserve behavior.